

FOUR WEEKS · PLAN · SHOP · PREP · REVIEW

The NourishWell Meal-Planning Workbook

Plan a month of easier, balanced meals

Weekly meal planners, shopping lists by aisle, prep-session plans and reviews, plus pantry and freezer inventories, a grocery budget tracker, a batch-cooking planner and blank recipe cards.

First edition · 2026

Eat Better. Feel Stronger. Live Well.

INSIDE THIS WORKBOOK

Contents

Start with the two short guides, then work through one week at a time. The reference pages at the back are there whenever you need them; print extra copies of any page for your own use.

How to use this workbook Plan, shop, prep, review 3

Build a balanced plate A simple guide for planning meals 4

Your month at a glance Busy days, go-to meals and staples 5

Week 1 Meal planner, shopping list, prep session, review 6

Week 2 Meal planner, shopping list, prep session, review 10

Week 3 Meal planner, shopping list, prep session, review 14

Week 4 Meal planner, shopping list, prep session, review 18

Pantry inventory Cupboard staples and use-by dates 22

Freezer inventory What's frozen, and when to use it 23

Grocery budget tracker Planned, spent and the difference 24

Batch-cooking planner Portions, storage, labels and food safety 25

Recipe cards Eight blank cards for meals worth keeping 26

What you'll need

- A pencil and an eraser
- Your diary or calendar for the month
- A little time once a week to plan
- Containers and labels for prep days

About this workbook

It's a planning tool, not a diet. The guidance inside is general and practical, and there are no rules to follow perfectly. Skip any page that doesn't suit your week, and come back to it when it does.

GETTING STARTED

How to use this workbook

Each week follows the same simple rhythm: plan, shop, prep, review. Use as much or as little as suits you. Even planning a few dinners ahead can take some of the guesswork out of the week.

01 Plan

Sit down once a week with your diary. Mark the busy evenings first, then fill in the meal planner, starting with dinners. Pencil in one "cook once, eat twice" meal to cover a busy day.

02 Shop

Check the fridge, freezer and pantry pages before you write anything. Note what needs using up, then build the shopping list by aisle, straight from your plan.

03 Prep

Choose a prep session that fits your week: one longer slot or two short ones. Wash and chop, cook a grain or a pot of beans, and portion meals into labelled containers.

04 Review

At the end of the week, note what worked, what to swap and which meals to repeat. Carry leftovers and good ideas straight into next week's plan.

Reuse ingredients, waste less

- Roast a large tray of vegetables: serve them as a side one night, then add them to a grain bowl, wrap or soup.
- Cook a pot of grains or lentils once and build two or three meals around it.
- Pick one bunch of herbs and one leafy green for the week and use them in several dishes.
- Plan a use-it-up meal near the end of the week, such as a frittata, soup, fried rice or a tray bake.
- Freeze portions you won't eat in the next couple of days, and note them on the freezer inventory.
- Buy tins, jars and frozen staples you'll use across several meals, rather than one-off ingredients.

A sample weekly rhythm

BEFORE THE WEEK	A FREE SLOT	MIDWEEK	END OF THE WEEK
Plan & shop	**Prep session**	**Cook once, eat twice**	**Use up & review**
Fill in the planner, check the inventory pages, write the list.	Batch-cook, wash and chop, portion and label.	Turn one batch into a second, different meal.	A use-it-up meal, then a few notes for next week.

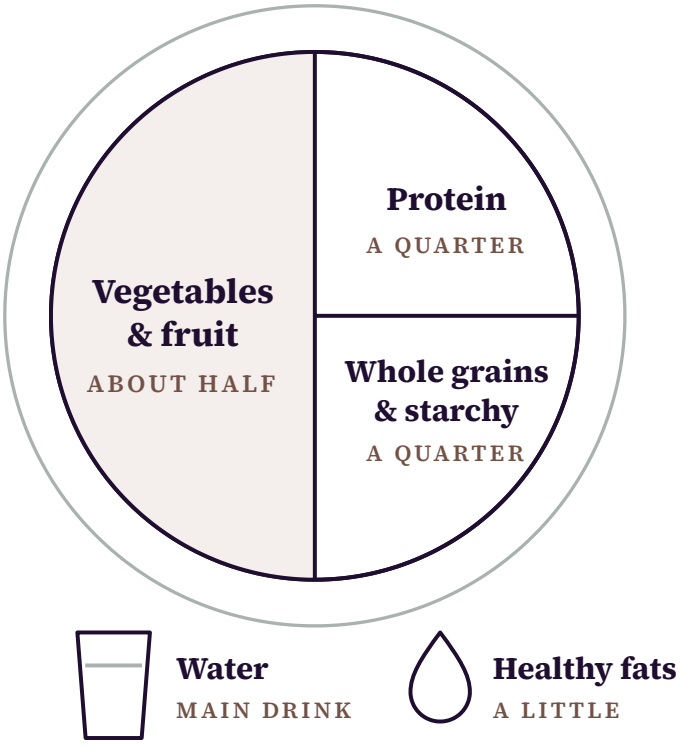
Printing. Pages are mostly white with fine lines, to go easy on ink. Print the weekly pages as many times as you need for your own use.

Pencil helps. Plans change. Write in pencil, or use sticky notes on the planner, so you can move meals around the week.

A ONE-PAGE GUIDE

Build a balanced plate

A quick visual check for planning meals. It isn't a rule for every plate: think about balance across the day and the week.



Vegetables & fruit ABOUT HALF

Mix colours and types across the week. Fresh, frozen and tinned all count; for tins, choose ones in water or juice, with no added sugar or salt where you can.

Protein ABOUT A QUARTER

Rotate between beans, lentils, chickpeas, tofu, eggs, fish, poultry and lean meat. Pulses are an easy, low-cost staple to keep in the cupboard.

Whole grains & starchy foods
ABOUT A QUARTER

Choose wholegrain or higher-fibre versions where you can: oats, brown rice, wholewheat pasta, wholegrain bread, potatoes with their skins on.

Healthy fats A LITTLE

Cook with or dress food with small amounts of oils such as olive or rapeseed oil, and add nuts, seeds or avocado now and then.

Water THROUGH THE DAY

Make water your usual drink, and keep a glass or bottle within reach at meals.

Using the plate when you plan

- Look at each dinner on your planner and ask: is there a vegetable, a protein, and a grain or starchy food?
- If a meal is light on vegetables, add an easy side such as a salad, frozen peas or a tray of roasted vegetables.
- Breakfasts, lunches and snacks can fill gaps: fruit with breakfast, a handful of nuts, a bean-based lunch.

> General guidance for healthy adults. If you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or follow a clinical diet, follow your clinician's advice.

Your month at a glance

MONTH _____

Sketch out the month before planning each week: which days are busy, when you'll shop and prep, and one new meal you'd like to try each week.

WEEK	WEEK OF	BUSY DAYS TO PLAN AROUND	NEW MEAL TO TRY	SHOP DAY	PREP DAY
1					
2					
3					
4					

Go-to quick meals

Meals you can make from staples on a tired evening.

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Staples to keep in stock

The cupboard and freezer basics that make those meals possible.

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

This month I'd like to...

_____

_____

_____

Weekly meal planner

WEEK OF _____

	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER	SNACKS
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				
Saturday				
Sunday				
Cook once, eat twice	COOK _____ EAT AGAIN AS _____		COOK _____ EAT AGAIN AS _____	

NOTES

Shopping list

SHOPPING DAY _____

Use up first

Check the fridge, fruit bowl and inventory pages before you shop, and plan these into the week.

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

PRODUCE

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

PROTEIN

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

DAIRY & ALTERNATIVES

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

GRAINS & BAKERY

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

TINS & JARS

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

FROZEN

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

HERBS & SPICES

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

OTHER

- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

Prep-session planner

DATE _____ TIME AVAILABLE _____

Time blocks

Start whatever takes longest first, then chop, portion and wash up while it cooks.

TIME	TASK	DONE
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

What to batch-cook

RECIPE	PORTIONS	MEALS IT COVERS	STORE IN
			☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer
			☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer
			☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer
			☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer

Storage container checklist

- ☐ Containers clean, lids matched
- ☐ Shallow containers for quick cooling
- ☐ Freezer-safe boxes or bags
- ☐ Jars for sauces and dressings
- ☐ Labels and a pen ready
- ☐ Space cleared in the fridge
- ☐ Space cleared in the freezer
- ☐ Lunch boxes for the week

Weekly reflection

WEEK OF _____

What worked

Meals, routines or shortcuts that made the week easier.

What to swap

Anything that took too long, didn't get eaten or didn't suit the week.

Favourites to repeat

Add the best ones to your go-to list or a recipe card.

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Left over or thrown away

Buy a little less next time, or plan a use-it-up meal.

Carry into next week

Weekly meal planner

WEEK OF _____

	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER	SNACKS
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				
Saturday				
Sunday				
Cook once, eat twice	COOK _____ EAT AGAIN AS _____		COOK _____ EAT AGAIN AS _____	

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Shopping list

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- ☐ _____

PRODUCE

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
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- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

PROTEIN

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

DAIRY & ALTERNATIVES

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

GRAINS & BAKERY

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

TINS & JARS

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- ☐ _____
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- ☐ _____

FROZEN

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

HERBS & SPICES

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

OTHER

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Prep-session planner

DATE _____ TIME AVAILABLE _____

Time blocks

Start whatever takes longest first, then chop, portion and wash up while it cooks.

TIME	TASK	DONE
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
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		☐

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Meals, routines or shortcuts that made the week easier.

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Anything that took too long, didn't get eaten or didn't suit the week.

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- ☐ _____
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Carry into next week

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		☐

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		☐
		☐
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		☐
		☐
		☐

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- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Left over or thrown away

Buy a little less next time, or plan a use-it-up meal.

Carry into next week

Pantry inventory

DATE CHECKED _____

List cupboard staples: tins, jars, dried grains and pulses, oils, spices. Move items with the nearest dates to the front, and plan them in first.

ITEM	QTY	USE BY

ITEM	QTY	USE BY

Freezer inventory

DATE CHECKED _____

Note what you freeze, how much, and when to use it by. Check the pack or your local food-safety guidance if you're unsure how long something keeps.

ITEM	QTY	USE BY

ITEM	QTY	USE BY

MONEY

Grocery budget tracker

CURRENCY: _____ MONTH _____

Four-week summary

WEEK	PLANNED	SPENT	DIFFERENCE	NOTES
Week 1				
Week 2				
Week 3				
Week 4				
Month total				

Difference = planned minus spent. A positive number means you spent less than planned.

Shopping trips

DATE	WHERE	PLANNED	SPENT	NOTES

Ways to stretch the budget

- Check the pantry and freezer pages before writing your list, so you don't buy what you already have.
- Plan meals that share ingredients across the week.
- Compare the unit price on shelf labels, not just the pack price.
- Frozen and tinned vegetables, pulses and fish keep well and help cut waste.

Batch-cooking planner

MONTH _____

Record what you batch-cook, how many portions it made and where they're stored. Write the same date on the container label.

RECIPE	PORTIONS	STORE IN	LABEL DATE	EAT BY
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		
		☐ Fridge ☐ Freezer		

Keeping leftovers safe

- Cool leftovers quickly and refrigerate them within about 2 hours of cooking. Shallow containers help them cool faster.
- Eat refrigerated leftovers within 2–3 days, or freeze them.
- Reheat food until it is steaming hot all the way through.
- Label and date every container before it goes in the fridge or freezer.

Follow the food-safety guidance in your country.

Recipe cards

RECIPE

SERVES _____ PREP _____ COOK _____

INGREDIENTS

METHOD

1
2
3
4
5
6
7

☐ Freezes well ☐ Good for lunches ☐ Make again

RECIPE

SERVES _____ PREP _____ COOK _____

INGREDIENTS

METHOD

1
2
3
4
5
6
7

☐ Freezes well ☐ Good for lunches ☐ Make again

RECIPE

SERVES _____ PREP _____ COOK _____

INGREDIENTS

METHOD

1
2
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SERVES _____ PREP _____ COOK _____

INGREDIENTS

METHOD

1
2
3
4
5
6
7

☐ Freezes well ☐ Good for lunches ☐ Make again

Recipe cards

RECIPE

SERVES _____ PREP _____ COOK _____

INGREDIENTS

METHOD

1
2
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SERVES _____ PREP _____ COOK _____

INGREDIENTS

METHOD

1
2
3
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☐ Freezes well ☐ Good for lunches ☐ Make again

RECIPE

SERVES _____ PREP _____ COOK _____

INGREDIENTS

METHOD

1
2
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RECIPE

SERVES _____ PREP _____ COOK _____

INGREDIENTS

METHOD

1
2
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NourishWell

Find recipes, a free weekly meal planner and a shopping calendar at NourishWell.

Eat Better. Feel Stronger. Live Well.

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